

BRETT VENU SUMO EDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're here in Brisbane at a travel conference called Arrival 360. I'm with Brett Melville from the company VenuSumo and Brett, welcome to the program. Thanks for having me.

Now Brett, your company interfaces with other travel businesses to offer all-in-one operating system for attractions and tourism. Tell us about what you do. Yeah, absolutely.

So we work with a lot of different customers in the attractions, leisure and tourism space to help them sell their tickets online. But as well as that, have in-store capabilities with full-on point of sale, memberships, waivers, birthday party packages. So we actually got our start in the indoor attractions world.

So think indoor trampoline parks, indoor playgrounds, and that's where a lot of our customers come from. And then we have sort of pulled ourselves into the tourism part of the world through some customers in the zoo space and the visitor tourism center space in Victoria. Now you guys are tech guys, so you put together all of this back-end tech for the tourism operators, right? Yeah, correct.

So we're providing the infrastructure so they can sell tickets online. So I have links from their marketing websites where people can easily book a birthday package, a day pass, a one-hour session, two-hour session, gift card, membership, session voucher, anything they'd want to sell ticketing relating to their venue, as well as have our own native point of sale in store. So it has the versatility to be able to check in a booking that has been made online, make a booking for someone in store, still keep in mind all your capacity rules that you have with your venue, as well as sell a coffee or a muffin or a burger from a kitchen or someone is sitting at their table in the venue and they've got a QR code and they can order directly from a cafe or restaurant which is sitting inside the venue.

You know, when people go into a restaurant and they see the QR code thing, you're like the interface or one of the interface technology companies behind that. And VenuSumo, how did it all start? Was it just a couple of you guys, tech guys, you had an idea and you put this together? Yeah, so it actually all came about from our CTO who worked over 10 years with a group of three trampoline parks. He worked with them every week developing a solution and a platform to all of their needs, which evolved quite heavily over the 10 years that he was working with them.

Some of our founders actually ran their own family entertainment center businesses and they were about to open their second location and they actually heard from their fabricator about this guy Dale, who had this amazing code base that had been built out over 10 years. Yeah, they saw that platform, they had a demonstration of it and couldn't believe the functionality it had and they couldn't believe that this product wasn't in market. So they had experience in other software

endeavors, so they basically decided to partner with Dale, our CTO, to bring what is now VenuSumo to market.

This was about three and a half years ago now and we've quickly, you know, taken over the attractions and leisure space in Australia. We've also got customers in the US and UK and yeah, we're pushing into the tourism space as well. Okay, you're based in Melbourne and Melbourne is a fantastic city to be in and it was voted one of the most livable cities for many years.

Can you give us a couple of your favorite places in Melbourne for people who may not have visited there? Our office is based in Richmond, so I quite like getting out to all the different bars around the Swan Street and Church Street areas of Richmond. I'm a sucker for a decent steak, so I quite like, sort of simple, but I quite like Squire's Loft in Turack Road there in South Yarra. So they're probably a few of my favorite spots, but there's lots of great coffee and breakfast places around most cities and suburbs within Melbourne.

I live in the Bayside area, so I quite like some of the spots around there as well. Oh, the Bayside area offers a huge range of things and people can go down to the Mornington Peninsula and it's, I suppose, you must, like, for those people who haven't been, a trip to Portsea and Sorrento is really a must, isn't it? Blairgowrie as well and then even on the Western Port Bay side of things there's a lot of uncovered wineries that a lot of people haven't been to. The Red Hill area is quite good as well.

Yeah, so to find out more about VenuSumo, you can go to venusumo.com and read about all the different features that we offer and all the different types of businesses that we help. Brett Melville, VenuSumo, thank you for being on the program. Thanks, Geoff.

Cheers.